

Participant Information Sheet for LinTeX User Study

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Name of department: Computer and Information Sciences

Title of the study: LinTeX: Promoting Accessibility in LaTeX Documents

Introduction

I am Mohammad Danyal, a final year Undergraduate Computer Science student at the University of Strathclyde. I can be contacted by email via mohammad.danyal.2023@uni.strath.ac.uk should any concerns or questions arise regarding the study, or if you wish to withdraw your participation.

What is the purpose of this research?

Modern LaTeX documents utilize PDFLaTeX as opposed to LuaLaTeX. Thus, they often require workarounds to implement features and lack accessibility support.

LinTeX is a new tool under development to combat this concern, which aims to improve LaTeX documents by avoiding workarounds and suggesting modern LaTeX usage as an alternative, with emphasis placed on accessibility.

This user study aims to identify the effectiveness of a new tool, LinTeX, to promote accessibility in LaTeX documents, as well as its usability to a wider audience. Additionally, this user study aims to identify areas of improvement for LinTeX.

Do you have to take part?

Participation in the research is entirely voluntary.

Refusing to participate in or withdrawing from the study will not affect the ways an individual is treated.

Participants may withdraw from the study at any stage without providing a reason.

If you wish to withdraw from the study at any stage, please contact mohammad.danyal.2023@uni.strath.ac.uk.

What will you do in the project?

Participants will be requested to participate in an in-person think-aloud user study in the University of Strathclyde's campus at a pre-arranged time and date.

Participants will be provided the LinTeX website to interact with and requested to create a simple LaTeX document with features selected to identify where common workarounds are necessary.

Participants may add more to the LaTeX document if they wish.

Participants will be observed interacting with the system with no interjection from the researcher unless necessary.

After completing the think-aloud session, participants will be asked about their experience including if they found the end document to be more accessible than the document before applying it to the system, as well as any adjustments they would have found useful.

Why have you been invited to take part?

Participants of the research study may benefit from the LinTeX tool and have been asked to assist in its development through an in-person think-aloud user study.

Participants must be a member of the University of Strathclyde, or another higher education facility within travelable distance.

Participants will require basic knowledge of LaTeX to participate in the study and have been selected based on these criteria.

What information is being collected in the project?

Personal information that may be stored include the participants' names and email addresses. This data is stored to ensure communication is thorough in arranging a time and date to participate in the study. Additionally, some information stored about the participants' usage of the system or answers to questions may be personal.

Non-identifiable information that may be stored include anonymised information extracted from the user study.

Who will have access to the information?

Only the researcher will have access to any Personally Identifiable Information (PII). Anonymised information may be included in the research paper and shared with the supervisor.

Where will the information be stored and how long will it be kept for?

All data will be stored in password-protected folders on OneDrive, with Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and anonymous data stored in separate folders.

All data stored in these folders will be deleted on 1st August 2026. However, any data that is anonymised and included in the study may not be possible to remove.

Thank you for reading this information – please ask any questions if you are unsure about what is written here.

All personal data will be processed in accordance with data protection legislation. Please read our [Privacy Notice for Research Participants](#) for more information about your rights under the legislation.

What happens next?

If you are interested in the project, or continuing with the user study, please contact me by email via mohammad.danyal.2023@uni.strath.ac.uk. Participants will be requested to sign a consent form prior to participation in the user study.

All information collected in the user study will be anonymised before being published.

If participants are interested in participating in any future related studies, the aforementioned email address can be used to register your interest.

If you are no longer interested in participating in the project, no further steps will be required. Thank you for your time.

Researcher contact details:

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Chief Investigator details:

Brian Mitchell

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This research was granted ethical approval by the Department of Computer and Information Sciences Ethics Committee.

If you have any questions/concerns, during or after the research, or wish to contact an independent person to whom any questions may be directed or further information may be sought from, please contact: cis-ethics@strath.ac.uk